

Outlook

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Are failed ATM attempts forming an attack sequence?

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Cyber wants to know whether repeated PIN failures, balance enquiries and cash attempts form recognisable sequences before a card is blocked. There is no confirmed problem yet; this is a request to test an assumption before it becomes policy.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if specific terminals see repeated card testing?
2. What evidence would instead support that a balance enquiry followed by rapid withdrawals marks higher risk?
3. How do we rule out that normal forgotten-PIN behaviour dominates?

Please work towards which sequences should become monitoring rules and which would create unacceptable false positives. A useful output would be a working Excel file with the exception population and clear columns.

Use ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories. One caution: There is no CCTV, device fingerprint or complete card-network feed, so classify behavioural patterns rather than confirmed attacks.

Regards